THE PRIME MINISTER'S OFFICE
REGIONAL ADMINISTRATION AND LOCAL GOVERNMENT
LONGIDO DISTRICT MID TERM JOINT EXAMINATION

FORM THREE
024 LITERATURE IN ENGLISH
MARKING SCHEME AUGUST 2026

SECTION A (16 MARKS)

QUESTION 1

(i)	(ii)	(iii)	(iv)	(v)	(vi)	(vii)	(viii)	(ix)	(x)
B	B	C	C	C	C	B	C	C	B

01 mark x 10 = 10 marks

QUESTION 2

(i)	(ii)	(iii)	(iv)	(v)	(vi)
D	C	F	E	B	A

01 mark x 6 = 06 marks

SECTION B (54 MARKS)

QUESTION 3

(a) Distinguish between oral literature and written literature. — 3 marks

- **Oral literature** is literature transmitted mainly by word of mouth/performance from one person or generation to another. **(1½ marks)**
- **Written literature** is literature recorded in written/printed form and transmitted through books or other written media. **(1½ marks)**

Accept other accurate distinctions.

(b) Two characteristics of oral literature. — 2 marks

(i) It is transmitted orally.
(ii) It involves performance.
(iii) It may involve audience participation.
(iv) It uses repetition.
(v) It may involve songs, chants, proverbs, riddles or storytelling.
(vi) It can change from one performance to another.
(vii) It is often preserved through memory.
(viii) It may use gestures, facial expressions and movements.

(c) Any two advantages of oral literature to a community. — 4 marks

(i) **Preserves culture** — transmits customs, traditions and beliefs to younger generations.
(ii) **Educates society** — teaches morals, values and acceptable behaviour.
(iii) **Provides entertainment** — stories, songs and dances entertain members of society.
(iv) **Promotes unity** — communal performances bring people together.
(v) **Preserves history** — important events and experiences can be passed from generation to generation.
(vi) **Develops language** — enriches vocabulary and communication skills.

Total: 9 marks

QUESTION 4

(a) The persona is a street vendor (a mother/parent) who sells goods informally in the city. This is revealed through the details of her mat, tray, goods for sale, and her concern for her daughter's school fees. = **02 marks**

(b) The line suggests that the persona's motivation for enduring daily hardship and hard work is her hope and determination to secure a better future for her daughter through education. = **01 mark**

(c) "The city swallows light away" - the city (an inanimate/abstract entity) is given the human/animal action of swallowing, which is personification. = **01 mark**

(d) Poverty, resilience/hope, sacrifice for children's education, urban informal economy struggles, exploitation/neglect by a hurrying society. (any three) = **03 marks**

(e) The poem is still relevant today because:

(i) Many parents in urban areas still struggle daily in the informal economy to raise school fees for their children.

(ii) Informal traders/vendors are still largely ignored by busy, hurrying urban populations.

(iii) Poverty and the struggle to balance daily survival with children's education remain common today.= **02 marks**

Total = 09 marks

QUESTION 5

(a) Identify the literary device. — *4 marks*

(i) "The classroom was as silent as a grave."**Simile**
(ii) "The angry wind knocked at the windows..**Personification**
(iii) "Peter packed plenty of pencils..."**Alliteration**
(iv) "I have told you a thousand times..."**Hyperbole**

(b) Two differences between a simile and a metaphor. — **2 marks**

- A **simile** makes a comparison using words such as **"like"** or **"as"**, whereas a **metaphor** makes a direct comparison without necessarily using "like" or "as".
- A simile explicitly indicates comparison, while a metaphor presents one thing as being another for figurative effect.

(c) Three reasons why literary devices are important. — **3 marks**

(i) Make language interesting.
(ii) Create vivid mental pictures/images.
(iii) Emphasise important ideas.
(iv) Create rhythm and musicality.
(v) Help communicate emotions.
(vi) Make messages memorable.
(vii) Create humour.

Total: 9 marks

QUESTION 6

(i) Denouement/Resolution
(ii) Understatement
(iii) Autobiography
(iv) Idioms
(v) Non-fiction (literature)
(vi) Metaphor
(vii) Verbal irony
(viii) Apostrophe
(ix) Anaphora/Repetition

01 mark x 9 = 09 marks

QUESTION 7

(a) Any two characteristics of oral literature evident in the narrative. — **2 marks**

(i) It is presented in narrative/story form.
(ii) It contains a moral lesson.
(iii) It can be transmitted orally.
(iv) It involves human characters.
(v) It has a sequence of events.
(vi) It can be performed before an audience.
(vii) It can be accompanied by gestures or expressions.

(b) Moral lesson — **2 marks**

(i) We should **help others rather than laugh at their difficulties**.
(ii) We should **treat others with kindness and respect**.
(iii) Good deeds may return to benefit us.
(iv) We should not despise people who appear weak or helpless.
(v) We should learn from our mistakes and ask for forgiveness.

(c) — **2 marks**

Young people/students — because the narrative teaches them to respect, help and show kindness to others. **(2 marks)**

Accept children, community members, adults, etc., with a valid justification.

(d) any two ways the narrative can be transmitted. — **2 marks**

(i) Storytelling.
(ii) Teaching children orally.
(iii) Community performances.
(iv) Radio programmes.
(v) Recorded audio/video.
(vi) Written transcription.
(vii) Theatre/drama performance.

Total: 9 marks

QUESTION 8

(a) How setting can be effective in a literary work:

(i) It helps the reader visualize and understand the time and place of the events.
(ii) It creates mood/atmosphere that supports the theme of the work.
(iii) It can influence characters' behaviour and the development of the plot.

1.5 marks x 3 = 4.5 marks

(b) Literature mirrors society - justification:

(i) Literature reflects real social issues such as poverty, injustice and corruption found in society.
(ii) Characters and events in literature often resemble real people and situations in society.
(iii) Literature responds to and comments on the historical and cultural context in which it is written.

Any relevant points will be awarded. 1.5 marks x 3 = 4.5 marks

SECTION C (30 MARKS)

QUESTION 9

The student should choose two plays and show, using minor/comic characters, how the playwrights expose society's weaknesses. For example:

"The Trials of Brother Jero"

(i) The character of Chume exposes the gullibility of followers who blindly trust religious leaders.

(ii) Jero's dealings with minor characters expose the hypocrisy and manipulation common among self-styled prophets.

(iii) The comic treatment of Jero's followers exposes society's weakness for superstition and quick solutions.

"The Lion and the Jewel"

(i) The character of Lakunle exposes the shallow, imitative embrace of Western ways by some educated Africans.

(ii) The village girls/wooing scenes expose vanity and the community's obsession with beauty and status.

(iii) Sadiku's role exposes the way tradition can be used to manipulate and control women.

Any two relevant plays with three valid points each will be awarded.

Marks distribution: Introduction = 1.5 marks, Main body = 12 marks (02 marks@point), Conclusion = 1.5 marks. Total = 15 marks

QUESTION 10

Introduction: **1.5 marks**

6 marks For **each play**: total **12 marks**

Dialogue — 2 marks

- Correct explanation of how dialogue advances events/reveals information — **1 mark**
- Relevant example — **1 mark**

Characters — 2 marks

- Explanation of how characters develop plot/conflict/themes — **1 mark**
- Relevant example — **1 mark**

Setting — 2 marks

- Explanation of how setting influences events — **1 mark**
- Relevant example — **1 mark**

Acceptable plays

- *The Lion and the Jewel*
- *The Trials of Brother Jero*
- *The Dilemma of a Ghost*
- *The Government Inspector*

Conclusion **1.5 marks**

Total**= 15 marks**

QUESTION 11

Introduction: **1.5 marks**

6 marks For each poem with Correct identification and explanation and Relevant example

Poem 1

Technique 1 — 2 **marks**

Technique 2 — **2 marks**

Technique 3 — **2 marks**

The candidate should explain how the techniques contribute to:

(i) theme/message,

(ii) mood,

(iii) imagery,

(iv) emphasis,

(v) rhythm,

(vi) emotional appeal,

(vii) memorability,

(viii) audience response.

Poem 2
Technique 1 — 2 **marks**
Technique 2 — **2 marks**
Technique 3 — **2 marks**

(i) Simile
(ii) Metaphor
(iii) Personification
(iv) Alliteration
(v) Assonance
(vi) Repetition
(vii) Rhyme
(viii) Imagery
(ix) Symbolism
(x) Hyperbole
(xi) Irony
(xii) Apostrophe
(xiii) Onomatopoeia
(xiv) Contrast
(xv) Enjambment

The examples must be **relevant to the poem selected**.
Conclusion **1.5 marks**
Total = 15 marks